

F5 Daily Briefing - Tuesday, September 15, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

21

ANNOUNCEMENTS

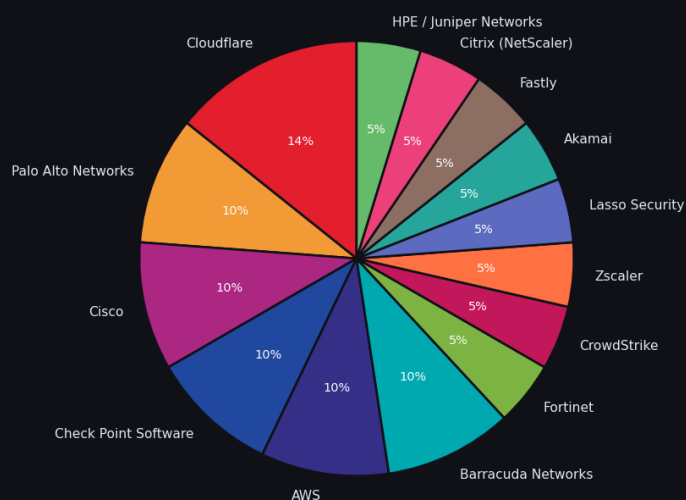
14

ACTIVE

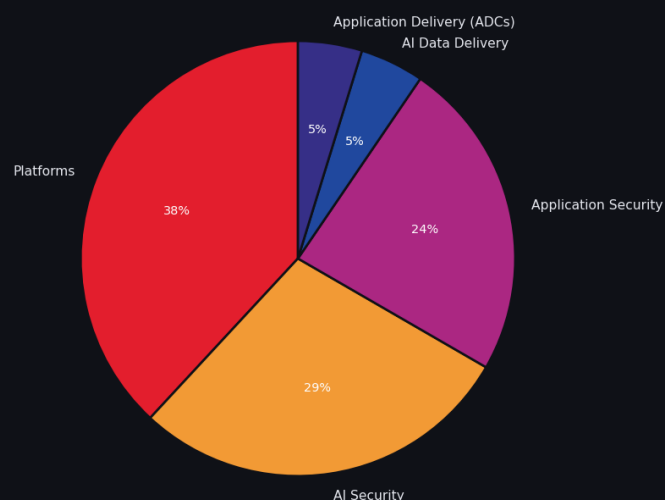
5

ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (21)

PRODUCT LAUNCH Palo Alto Networks 2026-09-15

Cortex Data Security Reaches General Availability

Palo Alto Networks moved Cortex Data Security to general availability after two months in public preview, positioning it as an AI-native operating model for protecting data across cloud, SaaS, AI, and on-prem environments. The release bundles DSPM-powered discovery and classification, unified DLP and DDR for Cortex XDR customers, AI lifecycle security, agentic SOAR automation via XSOAR and AgentiX, and access governance covering both human and AI-agent identities. An October follow-on adds DLP Harmonization and Unified DDR to centralize policy visibility and near-real-time detection across cloud data stores, SaaS, and AI infrastructure.

<https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/security-operations/cortex-data-security-ga-dlp-ddr/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH Palo Alto Networks 2026-09-15

Idara Extends Privileged Access Management to AI Agents

Palo Alto Networks unveiled Idara, an identity offering that extends privileged access management beyond human users to autonomous AI agents, building on its CyberArk integration. Rather than granting agents broad standing entitlements, Idara emphasizes runtime authorization, evaluating each individual action against target, data sensitivity, and risk before it executes. The launch signals that identity is becoming a core control plane for agentic AI security and puts Palo Alto in direct contention for the agent-governance layer enterprises are now building alongside AI runtime protection and guardrails.

<https://www.identityaccessmanagement.co.uk/palo-alto-networks-unveils-idara-following-cyberark-integration-identity-management-extends-to-ai-agents/>

EVENT

Fortinet

2026-09-15

Fortinet Opens \$60M New York City Innovation Hub

Fortinet opened a company-owned Innovation Hub in New York City, a 40,000-square-foot facility representing more than \$60 million of investment and tripling its prior NYC footprint. The site houses sales and other functions plus an Executive Briefing Center, a Cybersecurity Training Center, and a Fortinet Cloud point of presence powered by the company's ASIC technology for high-performance, AI-enabled security delivery. Fortinet is targeting financial services and regional enterprise customers with hands-on demonstrations, executive briefings, and training, expanding a global hub network that includes Chicago, Atlanta, London, and Sydney.

<https://www.fortinet.com/corporate/about-us/newsroom/press-releases/2026/fortinet-expands-us-presence-with-new-company-owned-innovation-hub-in-new-york-city>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Cisco

2026-09-15

Cisco Brings Splunk AI On-Premises With NVIDIA-Accelerated AI POD

Cisco announced Splunk advancements built to run, defend, and observe AI where customer data already resides. Cisco AI POD for Splunk delivers a pre-validated, Kubernetes-based AI runtime on Cisco hardware with NVIDIA acceleration for on-premises, private cloud, and air-gapped deployments, supporting Cisco's Deep Time Series model plus open models without data egress. Splunk Agent Observability adds Tokenomics for real-time AI token spend attribution and forecasting, along with runtime guardrails against unsafe agent actions. Cisco also signed a multi-year AWS agreement to co-develop an agentic security operations center.

<https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/cisco-delivers-trusted-ai-at-scale-through-new-splunk-advancements-302878467.html>

SECURITY ADVISORY

Cisco

2026-09-15

Cisco Patches Actively Exploited Secure Email Gateway Zero-Day

Cisco warned customers of an actively exploited zero-day in Cisco Secure Email Gateway running AsyncOS, rated CVSS 9.8, that allows unauthenticated remote code execution through crafted emails carrying malicious SQL statements. Both physical and virtual appliances are affected and no workarounds exist, so patching is the only remediation. Cisco PSIRT confirmed exploitation in the wild, and CISA added the flaw to its Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog with a September 17 federal remediation deadline. Cisco advises reviewing mail_logs on every device in a cluster for suspicious SQL patterns.

<https://cyberscoop.com/cisco-secure-email-gateway-zero-day-exploited/>

RESEARCH/REPORT

CrowdStrike

2026-09-15

CrowdStrike Research Details LLM-Generated PhantomRaven Stealer

CrowdStrike published research on PhantomRaven, an information stealer distributed through typosquatted npm packages that the company assesses with high confidence was largely generated by a large language model, citing verbose machine-style code comments. The actor, active since November 2022, used the bespoke malware to find exploitable conditions and claim bug bounty payouts from at least nine technology, retail, and hospitality companies rather than selling stolen data. CrowdStrike recommends private registries, restricting install script execution by default, and developer training on dependency-confusion attacks as AI tooling lowers attacker barriers.

<https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/blog/phantomraven-llm-generated-information-stealer-for-bug-bounty-hunting/>

RESEARCH/REPORT

Zscaler

2026-09-15

Zscaler Positions Deception as Frontline Countermeasure to AI-Enabled Attacks

Zscaler published product-insights research arguing that AI-enabled adversaries now automate reconnaissance, credential validation, exploit development, phishing and post-compromise data processing, collapsing defender detection windows. The piece positions deception — decoys, honeytokens, synthetic assets and canaries — as a strategic early-detection and containment layer that forces attackers to reveal themselves against fake targets. Drawing on five documented cyber-operation case studies, Zscaler maps network, web-application and AI-stack deception patterns, framing them as complementary to patching, identity hardening, ZTNA and DLP rather than a replacement, and tying deception telemetry into its wider Zero Trust and Agentic SOC narrative.

<https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/product-insights/countermeasures-ai-enabled-attacks-start-deception>

EVENT

Check Point Software

2026-09-15

Check Point to Debut AI Network Firewall and AI Defense Plane at GISEC Global 2026

Check Point announced it will showcase an AI-powered, prevention-first security lineup at GISEC Global 2026 in Dubai, headlined by its AI Network Firewall and AI Defense Plane. Four demonstration pods will feature live demos and customer use cases spanning hybrid networks, AI workloads and digital workspaces. The messaging centers on a unified security architecture delivering prevention, visibility and control across multivendor environments without adding operational complexity — reinforcing Check Point's consolidation pitch in the Middle East and its positioning that enterprises can secure AI adoption from infrastructure they already own.

<https://gecnewswire.com/check-point-software-to-showcase-ai-powered-security-at-gisec-global-2026/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Check Point Software

2026-09-15

Check Point Ships Synchronous Control Monitoring to Block Harmful AI Agent Actions in Real Time

Check Point introduced Synchronous Control Monitoring, a runtime alignment mechanism that inspects and blocks unsafe AI agent actions at the moment of execution rather than after the fact. Delivered as part of Check Point's AI security portfolio, it provides centralized policy enforcement over agent execution across managed workstations, giving security teams a control point for autonomous agents operating on endpoints. The capability extends Check Point's AI Defense Plane strategy into agent runtime governance and competes directly with runtime AI guardrail approaches, targeting enterprises deploying agentic AI on employee devices without existing execution-level controls.

<https://blog.checkpoint.com/ai-security/synchronous-control-monitoring-preventing-harmful-agent-actions-in-real-time/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Cloudflare

2026-09-15

Cloudflare Adds Per-Worker Granular Permissions for Teammates and AI Agents

Cloudflare introduced resource-level access control for its Developer Platform, letting administrators scope access to individual Workers instead of the whole account. Four new roles — Metadata Read-Only, Content Read-Only, Editor and Admin — can be assigned to members, user groups or scoped API tokens via dashboard, API or Terraform, with Durable Objects inheriting the parent Worker's permissions. Cloudflare explicitly frames the feature around least-privilege access for AI agents and CI/CD pipelines: debugging agents get metadata only, code-review agents get content read, automation gets Editor. Legacy Worker permissions keep working, with no deprecation date set.

<https://blog.cloudflare.com/workers-granular-authorization/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Cloudflare

2026-09-15

Cloudflare Launches “Accountable” AI Crawler Designation and Disallow AI Training Control

Cloudflare replaced its single Block AI Bots switch with three independent crawler controls — Search, AI Training and AI Agents — plus a new Disallow AI Training setting that lets sites stay indexed in search while refusing model training. Cloudflare also defined an “Accountable” crawler designation with four operator requirements, naming Apple, Google and Microsoft as meeting or aligning with the criteria. New defaults took effect for new domains and free-plan sites: ad-supported pages allow search crawling but block training and agent access. Managed Robots.txt is deprecated in favor of Bot Preference Sync.

<https://www.cloudflare.com/press/press-releases/2026/cloudflare-helps-end-the-search-or-ai-training-tradeoff/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Cloudflare

2026-09-15

Cloudflare WAF Managed Ruleset Moves SSRF and Command Injection Detections to Block

Cloudflare's September 15 WAF release promoted several Cloudflare Managed Ruleset detections from log-only to blocking. SSRF – Cloud – 3, which targets attempts to reach cloud instance metadata endpoints, and Command Injection – Generic 10 now block by default. The beta Version Control – Information Disclosure rule was merged into the original rule and also set to block, closing exposure of source-control history left on web roots. The update tightens default protection against cloud credential theft via SSRF, remote command execution and repository information disclosure without customer rule authoring.

<https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-09-15-waf-release/>

PARTNERSHIP

AWS

2026-09-15

AWS and Salesforce Expand Partnership to Embed CRM Data and Agents Across Both Platforms

AWS and Salesforce expanded their decade-long partnership to put CRM data, AI agents and model choice into everyday work tools. Salesforce data and context now surface in Amazon Quick; AWS frontier agents arrive in Slack starting with the DevOps Agent; and Agentforce gains model choice through Amazon Bedrock. Agentforce Voice will interoperate with Amazon Connect Customer over the Agent2Agent protocol for real-time bidirectional voice this fall, while Data 360 Zero Copy and Informatica headless expansions broaden cross-environment data access without migrations. Most integrations are generally available now.

<https://press.aboutamazon.com/aws/2026/9/aws-and-salesforce-put-crm-data-ai-agents-and-model-choice-into-the-tools-teams-use-every-day>

PARTNERSHIP

AWS

2026-09-15

Cognition and AWS Sign Multi-Year Strategic Collaboration Agreement for Devin

AWS and Cognition signed a multi-year Strategic Collaboration Agreement to help enterprises run Cognition's Devin autonomous software engineering platform in production on AWS. The agreement targets legacy workload migration, security backlog remediation and engineering debt reduction, with Devin already purchasable through AWS Marketplace alongside an Agent Toolkit for AWS. Both companies committed to deeper integrations into customer AWS environments. AWS cited existing deployments at Mercedes-Benz, Echo Global Logistics and ActiveCampaign as proof points, positioning agentic engineering on AWS as a mainstream modernization path rather than an experiment.

<https://press.aboutamazon.com/aws/2026/9/cognition-and-aws-sign-multi-year-collaboration-agreement>

RESEARCH/REPORT

Lasso Security

2026-09-15

Lasso Named a Leader in Latio's 2026 AI Security Market Report

Lasso Security was named a Leader in Latio Tech's 2026 AI Security Market Report, recognized as a major Platform Leader for intent-based runtime protection that models both what an AI application does and what it intends to do. The report highlights Lasso's flexible runtime engine categorization, risk prioritization and classification, first- and third-party AI agent discovery, AI red teaming, and visualization of LangChain-style agent workflows. Latio also credits Lasso's expansion to the endpoint and its ability to red team local agents, summarizing it as best for teams seeking discovery, runtime protection, and red teaming across agents.

<https://www.lasso.security/blog/lasso-named-a-leader-in-latios-2026-ai-security-market-report>

RESEARCH/REPORT

Akamai

2026-09-15

Akamai Named Strong Performer in 2026 Gartner Peer Insights for Secure Enterprise Browsers

Akamai announced it was recognized as a Strong Performer in the 2026 Gartner Peer Insights Voice of the Customer report for Secure Enterprise Browsers, its first appearance in the category following the LayerX Security acquisition. Akamai cited a 4.8/5 average rating and 92% willingness to recommend across 28 reviews. The post positions Akamai Workforce Protector, a lightweight browser extension securing AI and SaaS interactions in real time across Windows, macOS, Linux, iOS, and Android, including unmanaged and BYOD devices.

<https://www.akamai.com/blog/security/akamai-strong-performer-gartner-peer-insights-report-seb>

EVENT

Fastly

2026-09-15

Fastly Tells Investors Security Grew 43% as AI Traffic Nears Half of All Requests

At the Piper Sandler Growth Frontiers Conference, Fastly management reported 23% year-over-year revenue growth to \$183 million, with Delivery up 17% and Security up 43%. RPO rose 38% year over year. Executives said AI and agentic traffic now accounts for nearly half of total requests, driving security demand, with Bot Management and DDoS growing triple digits and WAF the strongest security product. Fastly emphasized multi-product adoption ahead of its September 22 Investor Day.

<https://stockanalysis.com/stocks/fsly/transcripts/718778-piper-sandler-5th-annual-growth-frontiers-conference/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Citrix (NetScaler)

2026-09-15

Citrix Launches AI-Powered Session Insights for User and Autonomous Agent Activity

Citrix introduced Session Insights, an AI-powered capability for Citrix SecurAccess with Chrome Enterprise that records and analyzes browser sessions for both human users and autonomous AI agents. It produces visual session evidence, AI-driven risk analysis, and policy recommendations so security teams can reconstruct what data moved and what an agent did before and after a risky action. Citrix frames it as governance and accountability for agentic AI workflows in the browser, with availability expected in October 2026.

<https://www.citrix.com/blogs/2026/09/15/introducing-ai-powered-session-insights/>

SECURITY ADVISORY

HPE / Juniper Networks

2026-09-15

HPE Networking Publishes Critical EdgeConnect SD-WAN Advisories, Including CVSS 9.8 Unauthenticated RCE

HPE Networking published its pre-announced batch of EdgeConnect SD-WAN security advisories, disclosing multiple high and critical vulnerabilities. They include CVE-2026-76674, a CVSS 9.8 buffer overflow allowing unauthenticated remote code execution on EdgeConnect SD-WAN Gateways, and CVE-2026-76670, a CVSS 9.9 authorization bypass in the EdgeConnect SD-WAN Orchestrator API enabling privilege escalation to administrator. Affected gateway builds span 9.4.x through 9.7.x, and HPE directs customers to upgrade to fixed releases immediately.

https://support.hpe.com/hpesc/public/docDisplay?docId=hpesbnw05126en_us&docLocale=en_US

RESEARCH/REPORT

Barracuda Networks

2026-09-15

Barracuda Uncovers Serverless Phishing Pages Rendered In-Browser via Blob URLs

Barracuda threat researchers detailed a phishing technique that builds credential-harvesting pages entirely inside the victim's browser using blob URLs, so there is no hosted malicious URL to block. The chain abuses legitimate Microsoft services such as login.microsoftonline.com and Teams redirects, then uses service workers and sandboxed iframes to control the flow in real time from a configurable backend. Barracuda urges defenders to monitor OAuth flows, blob URL usage, and service worker registrations, and to prioritize phishing-resistant authentication and browser-level behavioral detection over domain blocking.

<https://cxotoday.com/cybersecurity/barracuda-uncovers-serverless-phishing-pages-rendered-in-browser-via-blob-urls/>

RESEARCH/REPORT

Barracuda Networks

2026-09-15

Barracuda Research Flags Education Sector as Prime Email Attack Target

Barracuda research covered on September 15 found 536 educational institutions received roughly 58.8 million phishing emails over three months, about 1,200 per institution per day. Education showed the highest rates of email-initiated ransomware (38% of incidents) and account takeover (27%), while thin IT staffing slowed investigation, containment, and recovery. Barracuda argues schools need rapid detection and neutralization alongside prevention, and positions the gap as a clear managed-services opportunity for MSPs serving schools, colleges, and universities.

<https://www.channeldive.com/news/msps-needed-to-shore-up-school-security/830378/>